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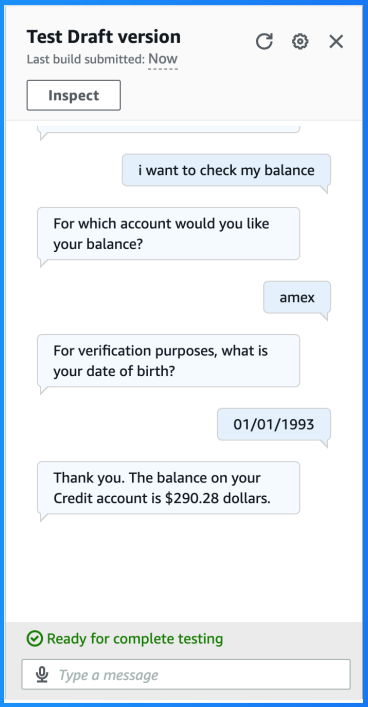
Connect a Chatbot with Lambda

James Paonessa



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Introducing Today's Project!

What is Amazon Lex?

Amazon Lex is a wonderful way to build a simple chatbot with connected functions including AI, Lambda function,s and much more.

How I used Amazon Lex in this project

Today we used Amazon Lex to connect our Lambda function and executre it when needed during the chat.

One thing I didn't expect in this project was...

I had a few tricky issues when linking. I had to clear the cache a few times to resolve the issues where the build didn't include all the changes with linking.

This project took me...

This project took roughly 30 minutes to build upon the previously built chatbot.

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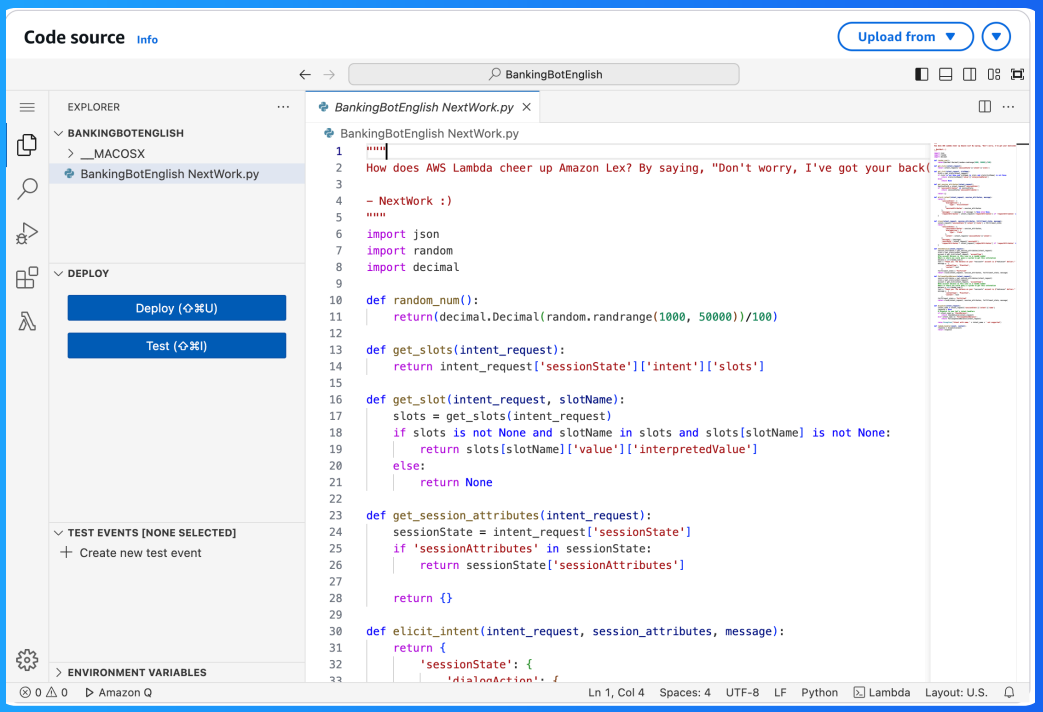
AWS Lambda Functions

AWS Lambda is a service that lets us run code directly in the cloud without needing to deploy Virtual Machines or other server systems.

In this project, I created a Lambda function to run a Python script that simulates pulling the balance of the requested account.



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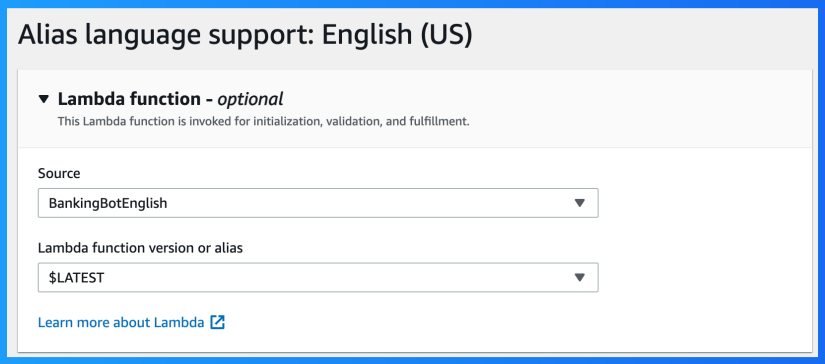
Chatbot Alias

An alias acts as a connection point between the function and a specific version of the bot.

TestBotAlias is the default version of my BankingBot used for testing and development.

To connect Lambda with my BankerBot, I visited my bot's TestBotAlias and within its settings, went to Alias Language support -> English -> Lambda Function. Here i was able to select my Lambda function and the bot verison.



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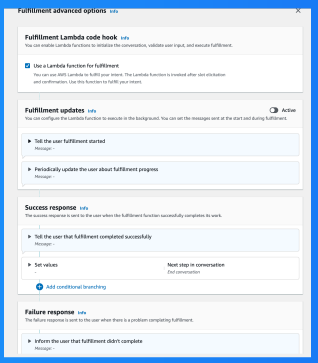
Code Hooks

A code hook is a great way to connect the chatbot to custom Lambda functions and execute code based on the discussion.

Even though I already connected my Lambda function with my chatbot's alias, I had to use code hooks because it allows the chatbot to instigate these specifically and integrate them into that portion of the chat.

I could find and instigate code hooks at the Intent -> Fulfillment portion.



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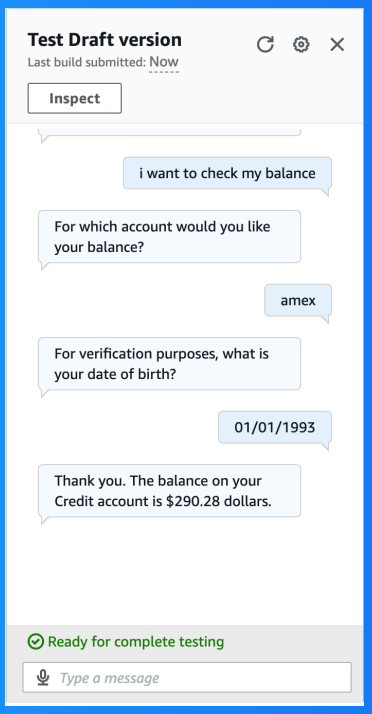
The final result!

I've set up my chatbot to trigger Lambda and return a random dollar figure when prompted with a verified account and date of birth.